

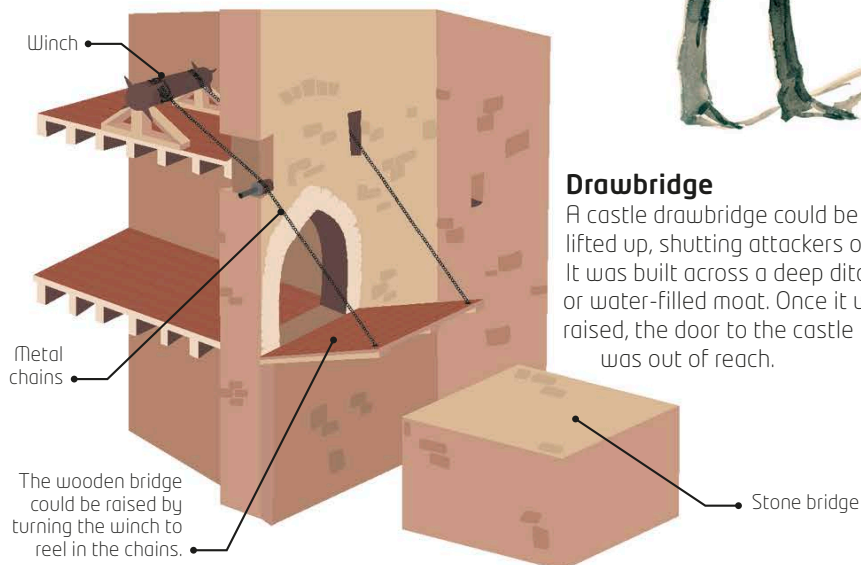
MEDIEVAL CASTLE

The walls of Bonaguil Castle tower like smooth cliffs over the French countryside. Every stone of this fortress was placed with the aim of keeping the people inside safe and their enemies out. Many walled castles were built across Europe during the wars of the medieval period. Most were homes and places of work as well as military structures.

Siege warfare

Castles were built with thick walls and strong defenses. If the enemy couldn't break through the walls, they would have to surround the castle, then wait for those inside to run out of food, water, and arrows.

A caricature of Viollet-le-Duc, with one of his projects, the Notre Dame cathedral in Paris.



Drawbridge

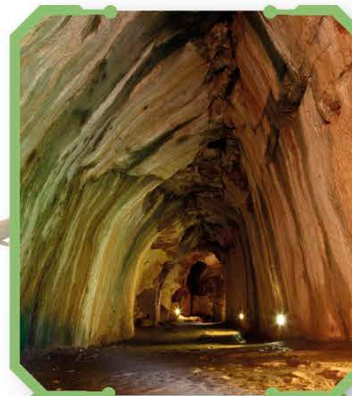
A castle drawbridge could be lifted up, shutting attackers out. It was built across a deep ditch or water-filled moat. Once it was raised, the door to the castle was out of reach.

Restoration craze

Many castles fell into ruin during the French Revolution, when many nobles were killed or fled the country.

But in the late 19th century, people began to take an interest in medieval buildings, led by the architect Eugène Viollet-le-Duc. He made drawings of Bonaguil but it wasn't restored as fancifully as some of the castles he visited.

Tiny windows were designed for defenders to shoot arrows from.



Hidden passage

A secret passageway was carved through the rock beneath Bonaguil Castle. It connects a number of defense posts within the castle walls, so defenders could move position undetected.



Conflicted territory

Bonaguil Castle is in southwest France, an area that was often fought over in medieval times. Perched on a rocky hill, it has a clear view of the surrounding land.

